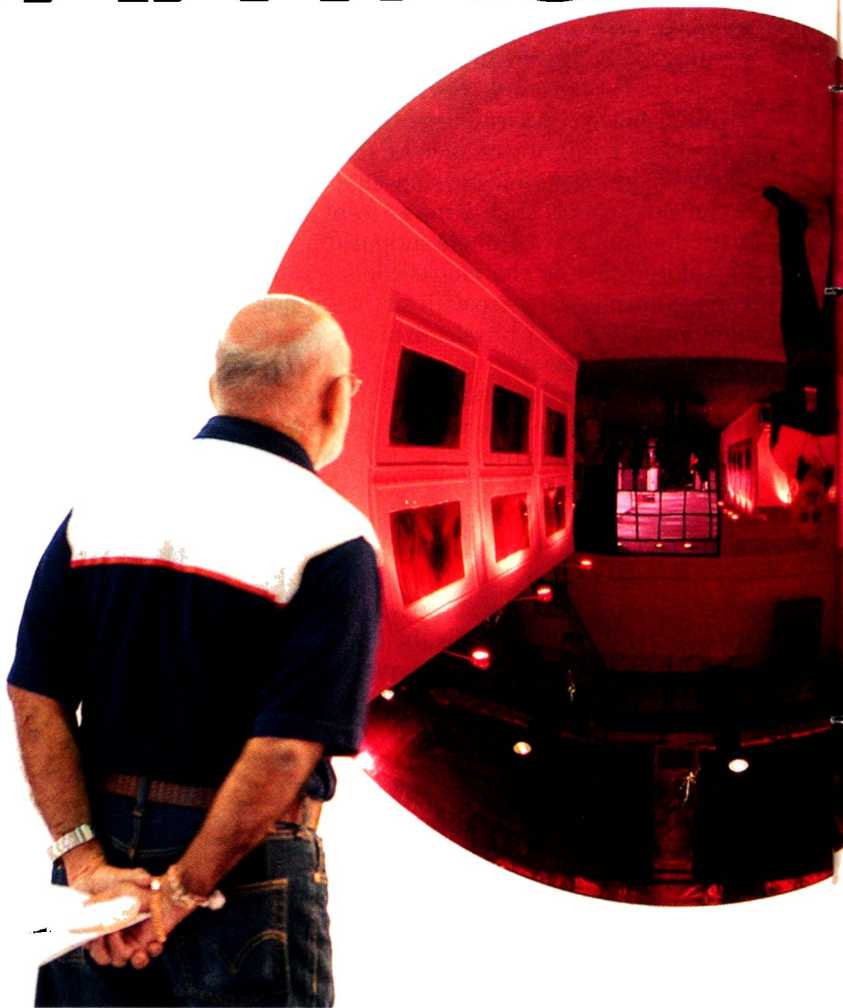


| By Nirmala Ravindran |

At a time when summits are all about doom and gloom, this was one to lift the spirits and suggest that at least art is, to some extent, recession-proof. Given the economic slowdown, organisers of last week's Indian Art Summit in Delhi choose to concentrate on creating a space for dialogue, fearing that sales would not be enough to pull in the crowds. They were in for a pleasant surprise. While the art market across the world has suffered due to the recession, the Indian Art Summit proved market analysts and critics wrong by managing to sell approximately 50 per cent of all works on display.

The second edition of the Indian Art Summit came back bigger and better—dismissing notions about last year's success being a one-off. With the participation of 54 galleries—17 are from countries like the Philippines, UAE, Korea, the Netherlands, Thailand, Germany, UK, USA, Japan, China and even Latvia, the summit has claimed a spot for itself in the global art market, and become India's single-largest platform for modern and contemporary arts. Not surprisingly, financial issues dominated most discussions at the Indian Art Summit, though its greatest

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achievement has been to broaden its artistic horizons. A sculpture park, a video lounge, collateral events within the campus as well as spread across the city helped create the right atmosphere for an event of national significance, while cocktail parties and receptions created endless opportunities for networking between gallery owners, curators, artists and collectors.

The sculpture park outside the venue was an attempt at creating

more visibility for sculptures and installations outside the boundaries of the gallery space. Ved Gupta's Dog Democracy presented by Threshold Art Gallery, Vibha Galhotra's Construction-Destruction-Resconstruction presented by Gallery Espace and Navjot Altaf's Touch—the 7-ft high Red Duco Paint on Fibre Glass sculpture—all stood out. Also evident was the mounting interest in video art with a non-stop video lounge curated by Anupam Poddar's Devi Art Gallery.